Terrence Ting-Yen Chen

Email: tychen@nyu.edu · Website: terrencechen.github.io

Education

Ph.D. in Sociology, New York University *2027 (exp.)*

Dissertation: The Fiscalization of Politics: Budget Talk as Political Justification in U.S. Congress, 1921–2024
Committee: Bart Bonikowski (Chair), Carly Knight, Alex Barnard, Jeff Manza, Elizabeth Popp Berman

M.Phil. in Sociology, New York University *2025*

B.A. in Sociology, National Taiwan University *2021*

Visiting Student, University of California, Berkeley *2019 – 2020*

Research Interests

Political Sociology, Culture, Economic Sociology, Computational Text Analysis, Comparative Historical Methods, Fiscal Policy, Democracy, Digital Technology

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen. 2026. Tracing Politicization in the U.S. Public Sphere, 1980–2024. *Sociological Science* 13: 1204-1240.

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen. 2026. When Does Digital Democracy Work? How Policy Domains Shape Government Responses to Online Petitions in Taiwan. *Information, Communication & Society*, 29:8, 2258–2275.

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen. 2024. Strong or Thin Digital Democracy? The Democratic Implications of Taiwan's Open Government Data Policy in the 2010s. *Big Data & Society*, 11:4.

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen. 2022. The Developmental State and Its Discontent: The Evolution of The Open Government Data Policy in Taiwan. *Third World Quarterly*, 43:5, 1056–1073.

Book Chapters

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen. 2025. Digital Democracy in a "Black-Box" Regime: The Conservative Origins of Taiwan's Open Government Policy, 2011–2016. In Deflem, Mathieu (Ed.), *Democracy, Governance, and Law* (pp. 43–58). Emerald Publishing Limited.

Works in Progress

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen. "Responsible Governance Liberalism: The Liberal Path to Fiscal Discipline in the U.S. since the 1970s" *(in preparation for submission)*

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen, Jo Redmond, and Alex Barnard. "Negotiate or Evict? University Administrative Responses to 2024 Gaza Solidarity Encampments" *(writing stage)*

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen, Jintae Bae, Sakeef Karim, and Milos Brocic. "Mapping the Relationship between Public and Personal Culture: The Case of 'Woke' in America" *(analysis stage)*

Chen, Terrence Ting-Yen. "Welfare State Expansion Under Financialization: Uneven Neoliberalization in Taiwan and South Korea in the 1980s" *(analysis stage)*

Conference Presentations

"Governing Responsibility Liberalism: The Liberal Path to Fiscal Discipline in the U.S. since the 1970s"

- 2026 ASA Junior Theorists Symposium. New York City.

- 2026 Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics Annual Conference. Bordeaux, France.

"Mapping the Relationship Between Public and Personal Culture: A Computational Text Analysis of 'Woke' in America" (with Jintae Bae, Sakeef Karim, and Milos Brocic)

- 2026 American Sociological Association Annual Conference. New York City.

"The Fiscalization of Politics: Budget Talk as Political Justification in U.S. Congress, 1921–2024"

- 2025 American Sociological Association Annual Conference. Chicago.

"The Ideological Politicization of U.S. Public Discourse, 1980–2023."

- 2024 American Sociological Association Annual Conference. Montreal, Canada.

"How Is the Welfare State Possible under Neoliberalism? Uneven Neoliberalization in Taiwan and South Korea in the 1980s"

- 2024 Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics Annual Conference. Limerick, Ireland.
- 2023 Social Science History Association Annual Meeting. Washington, D.C.
- 2022 History & Political Economy Project Conference. Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore.

"When Does Digital Activism Work? Examining Government Responses to Online Petitions in Taiwan."

- 2023 International Sociological Association World Congress of Sociology. Melbourne, Australia.
- 2023 Eastern Sociological Society Conference. Baltimore.

"The Unfulfilled Promise of Digital Democracy: Taiwan's Open Government Data in the 2010s."

- 2022 American Sociological Association Annual Conference. Los Angeles.
- 2021 North American Taiwan Studies Association Annual Conference. Online.

"Information Technology and State-Building: The History of Government Computerization in Taiwan, 1970–1980."

- 2021 Taiwan STS Association Annual Conference. Online.

"Political Process, Information Technology, and Connective Action: A Study of 'Campaign Finance Crowdsourcing' Project in Taiwan." (with Li Hsu)

- 2019 Annual Conference of Taiwan Academy for Information Society. Hsinchu, Taiwan.
  Honorable Mention in Best Student Paper Award

Invited Talks

"Introduction to Computational Text Analysis"

Guest Lecture, Social Research Seminar, Amherst College, 2026 Spring

"When Does Digital Activism Work? Examining Government Responses to Online Petitions in Taiwan"

The Andrea Mitchell Center for the Study of Democracy, University of Pennsylvania, 2023 Spring

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

ASA Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grants (ASA DDRIG)	2026
NYU Global Research Initiatives Fellowship	2026
NYU GSAS Predoctoral Summer Fellowship	2025
Society for the Advancement of Socio-Economics Early Career Workshop	2024
Identities & Ideologies Project Research Grant (NYU)	2023
History & Political Economy Project Summer Research Grant	2022

Scholarship of Government Sponsorship for Overseas Study, Taiwan's Ministry of Education 2021–2025
College Student Research Creativity Award, Taiwan 2020
College Student Research Scholarship, Taiwan's Ministry of Science and Technology 2019–2020
Honorable Mention, Best Student Paper Award at Annual Conference of Taiwan Academy for Information Society 2019
Second Place, Undergraduate Thesis Award at National Taiwan University 2019

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Computational Text Analysis (Ph.D. Level), New York University 2027 Spring (expected)
Teaching Assistant, Sociological Theory, New York University 2025 Fall
Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Sociology, New York University 2023 Fall, 2024 Spring, 2025 Spring
Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Sociology, National Taiwan University 2021 Spring

Skills

Methods: Computational text analysis (LLMs, word embeddings, topic modeling); historical archival research; regression and panel models; in-depth interviewing
Programming: R, Python, HPC computing
Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent)

Service

ASA Junior Theorists Symposium

2026–present Organizer, Junior Theorists Symposium 2027

Department of Sociology, New York University

2023–24 Academic Chair, Graduate Student Association

2022–23 Faculty Meeting Student Representative, Graduate Student Association

Invited Reviewer

Big Data & Society, New Political Economy, Globalization